

FreeRTOS Lab 1

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Outline

- Requirements
- STM32 Ports
- Tasks
- Queue
- Button debounce
- Grading

Requirements

- Use FreeRTOS multi-task and intertask communications.
- Use button to control LEDs blinking.
 - Implement button debounce function to avoid multiple rapid detections.
- [Demo Video](#)

Requirements

There are two tasks: **LED-task** and **Button-task**

LED-task have two states (S1, S2):

- **S1**: First, the **Red LED** lights up for 1 second, followed by the **Orange LED** lighting up for 1 second, then the **Green LED** lights up for 1 second. This sequence repeats, cycling through the Red, Orange, and Green LEDs. Only one LED is on at any given time.
- **S2**: Only **Orange LED** is blinking for 0.5 sec.

Requirements

Button-task detected whether the button is pressed.

- If the button is **short-pressed**, the LED-task will change its state ($S1 \rightarrow S2$) and ($S2 \rightarrow S1$).
- If the button is **long-pressed** ($> 1\text{sec}$), the LED-task will be suspended, and long pressed again will resume the LED-task.

STM32 Ports

LEDs

- LD1 COM: The LD1 default status is red. LD1 turns to green to indicate that communications are in progress between the PC and the ST-LINK/V2-A.
- LD2 PWR: The red LED indicates that the board is powered.
- User LD3: The orange LED is a user LED connected to the I/O PD13 of the STM32F407VGT6.
- User LD4: The green LED is a user LED connected to the I/O PD12 of the STM32F407VGT6.
- User LD5: The red LED is a user LED connected to the I/O PD14 of the STM32F407VGT6.
- User LD6: The blue LED is a user LED connected to the I/O PD15 of the STM32F407VGT6.
- USB LD7: The green LED indicates when V_{BUS} is present on CN5 and is connected to PA9 of the STM32F407VGT6.
- USB LD8: The red LED indicates an over-current from V_{BUS} of CN5 and is connected to the I/O PD5 of the STM32F407VGT6.

Push-buttons

- B1 USER: The user and wake-up buttons are connected to the I/O PA0 of the STM32F407VG.
- B2 RESET: The push-button connected to NRST is used to RESET the STM32F407VG.

STM32 Ports - Pin Assignments

Configure the LED

- Left-click on PD12, set it to GPIO_Output (it will turn green).
- Right-click on PD12, select Enter User Label, and name it GREEN_LED (or any preferred name).
- Repeat the process for PD14 (RED_LED) and PD13 (ORANGE_LED).

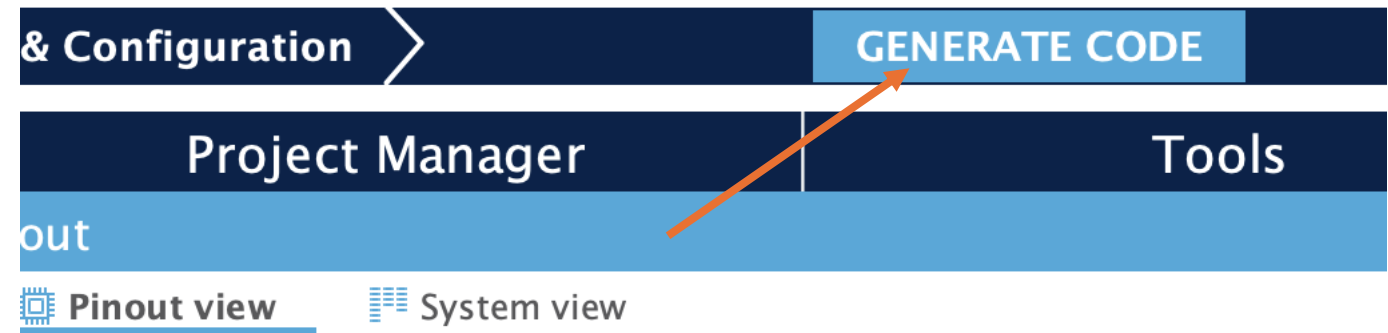
Configure the Button

- Left-click on PA0, set it to GPIO_Input (it will turn green).
- Right-click on PA0, select Enter User Label, and name it BLUE_BUTTON (or any preferred name).

Important Note

- Label names can be customized but avoid spaces
- Press Ctrl + S to save your settings
- Remember to comment out the handlers discussed in Lab 0

STM32 Ports



Save the .ioc file and generate code.



STM32 Ports - APIs

Read and write GPIO by utilizing the following APIs.

```
GPIO_PinState HAL_GPIO_ReadPin(const GPIO_TypeDef *GPIOx, uint16_t GPIO_Pin);  
void HAL_GPIO_WritePin(GPIO_TypeDef *GPIOx, uint16_t GPIO_Pin, GPIO_PinState PinState);  
void HAL_GPIO_TogglePin(GPIO_TypeDef *GPIOx, uint16_t GPIO_Pin);
```

Example of lights-up Red LED:

```
HAL_GPIO_WritePin(GPIOD, GPIO_PIN_14, GPIO_PIN_SET);
```

Task

- A Task is a small program should never return so are typically implemented as infinite loop.
- A task should have the following structure

```
void vATaskFunction( void *pvParameters ) {  
    for( ;; ) {  
        // -- Task application code here. --  
    }  
}
```

Task - Creation

A task is created by [xTaskCreate](#)

Parameters list:

pvTaskCode	Pointer to the task entry function.
pcName	A descriptive name for the task.
uxStackDepth	The number of words (not bytes!) to allocate for use as the task's stack.
pvParameters	A value that is passed as the parameter to the created task.
uxPriority	The priority at which the created task will execute.
pxCreatedTask	Used to pass a handle to the created task.

Example of creating a task:

```
TaskHandle_t xLEDHandle = NULL;  
xTaskCreate(ledTask, "LEDTask", 128, NULL, 1, xLEDHandle);
```

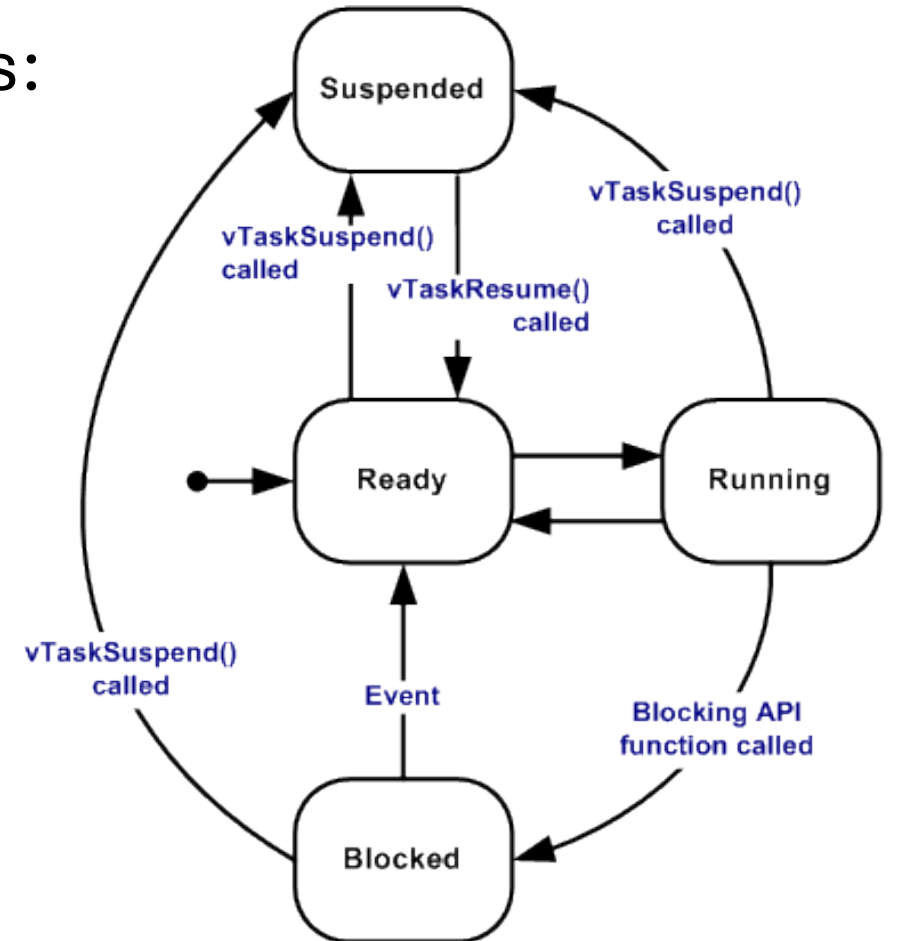
Task - State

A task can exist in one of the following states:

- Running
- Ready
- Suspended
- Blocked

Example of suspend a task (vTaskSuspend):

```
vTaskSuspend(xLEDHandle);
```



Task - Priorities

Each task is assigned a priority from 0 to (`configMAX_PRIORITIES - 1`), where `configMAX_PRIORITIES` is defined within `FreeRTOSConfig.h`.

Low priority numbers denote low priority tasks. The idle task has priority zero.

```
#define configTICK_RATE_HZ ((TickType_t)1000)
#define configMAX_PRIORITIES (56)
#define configMINIMAL_STACK_SIZE ((uint16_t)128)
```

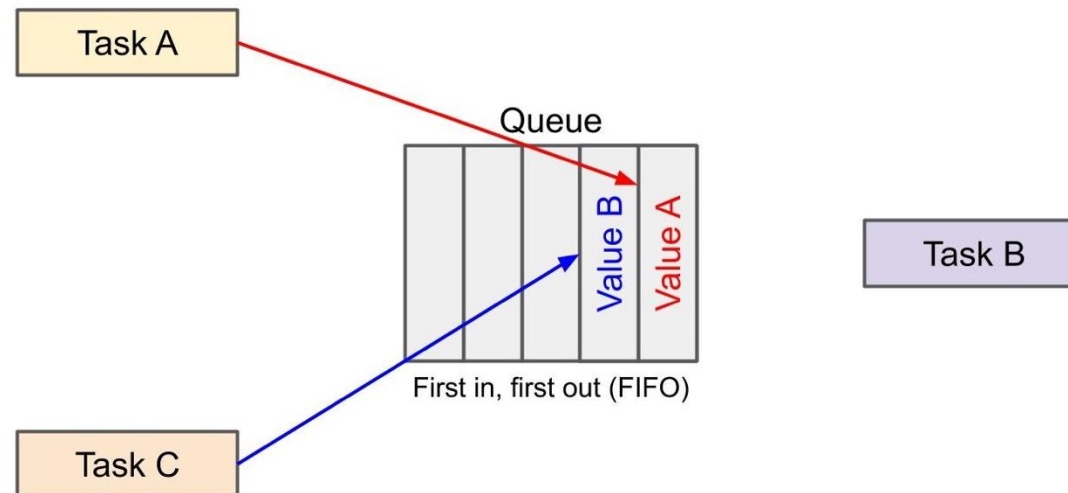
Task - Scheduler

[vTaskStartScheduler](#) starts the RTOS scheduler. After calling the RTOS kernel has control over which tasks are executed.

```
xTaskCreate(LEDTask, "LED Task", 128, NULL, 3, &LEDHandler);  
xTaskCreate(ButtonTask, "Button Task", 128, NULL, 1, &ButtonHandler);  
vTaskStartScheduler();  
  
while (1) {  
    | // Should never reach here  
}
```

Queue

- Queues are the primary form of intertask communications.
- Messages are sent through queues **by copy** not by reference.
- FreeRTOS does not define the message structure, allow users to define.
 - Small messages that are already contained in C variables (integers, small structures, etc.) can be sent into a queue directly.
 - For large data, a message can be just a pointer to the data item to avoid large copying overhead.



Queue

Creates a new queue and returns a handle by which the queue can be referenced.

Example of creating a queue contain 5 elements:

```
xQueueHandle queueHandler;  
queueHandler = xQueueCreate(5, sizeof(uint8_t));
```


Queue

xQueueSend and xQueueReceive can be used to send/receive an element.

Sender

```
uint8_t signal = 1;  
xQueueSend(queueHandler, &signal, 0);
```

Receiver

```
uint8_t recv;  
if (xQueueReceive(queueHandler, &recv, 0) == pdPASS) {  
    /* recv now contains a copy of xMessage. */  
}
```

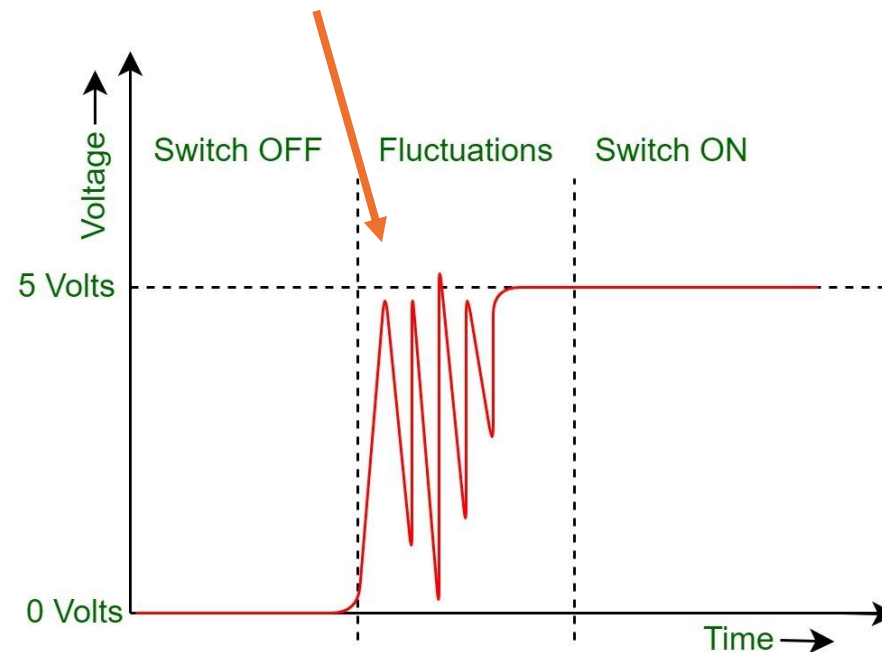
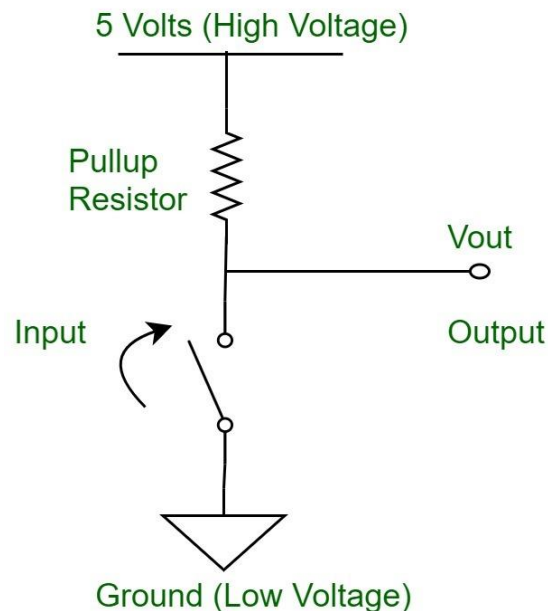
Queue

Blocking on queue

- Sending to a full queue → block until space is available or timeout occurs.
- Receiving from an empty queue → block until data arrives or timeout occurs.
- If multiple tasks are blocked on the same queue, the highest-priority task is unblocked first.
- Parameter `xTicksToWait` is the maximum amount of time the task should block wait.

Button Debounce

Mechanical switches bounce when pressed, causing multiple rapid detections instead of a single press. This can lead to unintended multiple task executions



Button Debounce

There are many ways implement software debouncing.

e.g. Adding a delay after detecting a button press.

vTaskDelay: Delays the task in ticks, allowing other tasks to run.

```
while (HAL_GPIO_ReadPin(GPIOA, GPIO_PIN_0) == GPIO_PIN_SET) {  
    vTaskDelay(10);  
    while (HAL_GPIO_ReadPin(GPIOA, GPIO_PIN_0) == GPIO_PIN_SET &&
```

Grading

Including **Demo** and **Report**

- **Demo (5%)**
 - (1%) At least one LED state is correct.
 - (1%) The LED state changes after pressing the button.
 - (1%) The LED state matches the lab requirements after short-pressed the button.
 - (2%) The LED-task suspend after button been long-pressed.
- **Report (3%)**
 - Write according to the format given on Moodle.
 - Please submit a PDF file with the file name as `studentID_labNo.pdf`
 - e.g. `P76144906_lab1.pdf`
- The Report must be uploaded on Moodle before 23:59 on 3/27; submissions after the deadline will not be graded.

Useful Links

- [UM1472 User manual - Discovery kit with STM32F407VG MCU](#)
- [Task Creation – FreeRTOS](#)
- [Task Control - FreeRTOS](#)
- [Intertask Communications - FreeRTOS](#)